



Google smart AR glasses

Google is making plans for the Metaverse starting with smart AR glasses.
<https://dgit.in/jan22-19>



5G India rollout

5G telecom services to be rolled out in selected cities across India in 2022.
<https://dgit.in/jan22-20>

Sony HT-A7000

A fantastic modular soundbar

While the debate for soundbar vs home theatre is a never-ending one, we can safely say that soundbars have started offering a very immersive experience. Here, we have Sony's flagship modular soundbar – the HT-A7000. You can purchase the soundbar separately with the option of two different wireless subwoofers and can invest in rear surround speakers later if you like. Let's see how it fares.

BUILD AND DESIGN

In the box, you get the soundbar itself along with an HDMI cable, power cable remote control, and audio cable. It is an HDMI 2.1 cable and

HT-Z9F, with a few key features moved around. The remote control is functional, intuitive and easy to use. Its only downside is that you need to point it directly at the soundbar to use.

CONNECTIVITY

The Sony HT-A7000 has an HDMI port for eARC and two HDMI pass-through ports. The soundbar also has an optical port, aux port, Bluetooth 5.0 and Wi-Fi. The speaker also boasts support for DTS-X, Dolby Atmos and Sony's own 360 Reality Audio.

PERFORMANCE

For the course of the review, we

speakers. The movie enthusiast who has access to good surround sound content will definitely enjoy the effects this soundbar has to offer. The soundbar has sound presets like Cinema, Movie and Standard, but we found that leaving it on Auto Sound yielded the best results.

We tested the soundbar in a 12-feet by 14-feet room and it was more than enough to bring the house down. For the most part, we left the soundbar at 60 percent volume and got a very rich experience. Going beyond 80 percent made the room vibrate considerably.

The soundbar does have quite pronounced bass in music and you can manually tune this down if you like.

Once again, the channel separation and surround effects work really well. In a game like Uncharted 4 when you are in the middle of a firefight, you can hear the bullets whiz all around you. Similarly, in a game like Spider-man Miles Morales, you get this immersive surround effect when you trigger your Venom powers.

the soundbar has two HDMI 2.1 passthrough ports. In the subwoofer box, we get just the subwoofer and the power cable. In the satellite speakers' box, we get two satellite speakers and two power cables.

The Sony HT-A7000 has a very commanding presence when placed below your TV. The front of the HT-A7000 has a grill with a premium finish behind which we have five drivers. Unlike the HT-Z9F, this grill is not removable. We also have two beam tweeters for the surround effects. There are two upward-firing drivers as well. The left and the right of the soundbar have two ducts that house the dual built-in subwoofers. You also have touch controls on the top right corner of the soundbar. Its length is just right to fit below a 55-inch or even 65-inch TV. All in all, the soundbar is well built.

The Sony HT-A7000 comes with a simple remote control that's almost identical to the one found on the

paired the Sony HT-A7000 with an LG B9 OLED TV. If you have a compatible Sony BRAVIA TV, then you can use the TV as the centre channel.

Before we get into the details of the performance, we have always had one problem with soundbars boasting of Dolby Atmos sound – you never feel like the sound is coming from exactly above you. This feeling is amplified when you play Dolby Atmos content and expect the rain to fall from above you. With the Sony HT-A700, we are happy to say that there were moments when we looked up at the ceiling, wondering if we heard the sound from above us or were our minds playing tricks on us.

Straight off the bat, we'd like to tell you that for the best immersive experience, you should invest in the SW5 subwoofer and the rear speakers. In a movie like Ready Player One's race at the 13-minute mark, you have a lot of cars whizzing by the screen. This was very well represented in the surround



BUILD	70
FEATURES.....	97
PERFORMANCE.....	85
VALUE.....	75

VERDICT

The Sony HT-A7000 is a fantastic soundbar for the home theatre enthusiast who doesn't want to run cables through his house. It has a simple plug and play setup and the soundbar can auto-calibrate itself to your room. It supports all popular formats including Dolby Atmos and Sony's own 360 Reality Audio. It has two HDMI 2.1 ports for a 4K 120Hz pass-through. It has excellent build quality. The overall sound quality is absolutely immersive with a decent representation of Dolby Atmos height channels via its up-firing drivers. The only downside is that the soundbar is very premium priced.

—Sameer Mitha

SPECIFICATIONS

WEIGHT: 8.7 kg | AMPLIFIER TYPE: Digital Amplifier, S-Master HX | AMPLIFIER CHANNELS: 11ch | POWER OUTPUT (TOTAL): 500W | SUBWOOFER TYPE: Built-in | I/O: Optical-audio input, Analogue audio input (stereo mini), USB type A, File System: exFAT/FAT12/16/32, vFA | BLUETOOTH VERSION: 5.0 | DOLBY VISION COMPATIBLE: Yes | SPEAKER LAYOUT: 7.1.2ch (Built-in-Subwoofer)

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